Tenant Communication and Rent Playbook

Park: _____ **Date:** _____

Part G: Own it.

Takes in: closing and the rent roll.

Hands to: AS-30.

You bought the park. Now dozens of households are watching what you do first. Get the first 30 days right and the rent conversation gets easy.

Notice periods, increase rules, and eviction law vary by state. Confirm every step with your attorney before you send anything.

Fair housing guardrail: ask about conduct and payment history only, never protected characteristics. Rules describe conduct, never who people are.

1. The new-owner letter: send in week one

"Dear residents of [park name],"

"My name is [name]. I purchased the park on [date] and I will be your new owner and operator."

"Your lease terms do not change today. Rent is due on the [day] as before, payable to [new payee] at [address or method]."

"My manager is [name], reachable at [phone]. For emergencies: [number]."

"I will be walking the park this week to introduce myself. [Your name]"

2. Rules reissue

- ☐ Reissue the rules in writing within the first 30 days. Verbal rules are not rules.
- ☐ One rule change at a time. Never a full rewrite in week one.
- ☐ Rules describe conduct: noise, trash, vehicles, payments. Never who people are.
- ☐ Enforce the written rules evenly, starting with yourself.

3. Rent-increase logic

- Raise on the market, not on the mood. Benchmark first (AS-29, Local Market Benchmark Builder).
- Give the notice your state requires, then add two weeks of your own.
- Explain the why once, in the letter: what the money fixes.
- Grandfather nothing in writing that you do not mean.

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4. Delinquency escalation

Step	Action	Timing
1	Friendly written reminder	Day 3
2	Formal late notice per the lease	Day 10
3	Payment plan offer, in writing	Day 15
4	Attorney referral	Per state law: confirm with your attorney

The Day 3/10/15 timing above is a rule of thumb, verify locally. Your lease and state law control the timing.

5. Resident relations

- Learn 10 names in the first week.
- Fix one visible thing in the first 30 days. Everyone sees it.
- The manager sets the tone. Back them in public, correct in private.
- Document every notice and payment plan in writing. Paper beats memory in court.

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Worked example

Fictional example: Maple Bend Estates. The increase below is market math, not a mood.

Step	Math	Result
Walk-verified occupied lots		41
Current average lot rent		$410
Market rent benchmark (AS-29)	from your ten calls	$450 (fictional)
Increase to	market minus a cushion	$430
Monthly increase per lot	430 - 410	$20
Annual increase, full collection	41 x 20 x 12	$9,840
Notice given	state minimum + 2 weeks of your own	90 days (fictional)

The $9,840 is gross, not collected. The delinquency process keeps it honest: friendly reminder, formal notice, payment plan, attorney. Timing is a rule of thumb, verify locally. Your lease and state law control the timing.

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The Doctrine

The belief this tool shatters is that the deal ends at closing. Closing is when you inherit a community that is watching your first move. The one rule: the first 30 days decide the next 10 years. One letter, one walk, one rule change at a time, one visible fix. Rent increases are market math, explained once, with the notice your state requires and two weeks of your own added on. Delinquency is a process, not a personality: written reminders on the schedule your lease and state law control. Rules describe conduct, never people. Enforce them evenly, starting with yourself. The owner who shows up in person in week one collects more rent in year one than the owner who mails a management company. Presence is the policy.

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